Broadcasting and narrowcasting Swedish preschool

“What happens to children’s participation when documentation becomes digital?”

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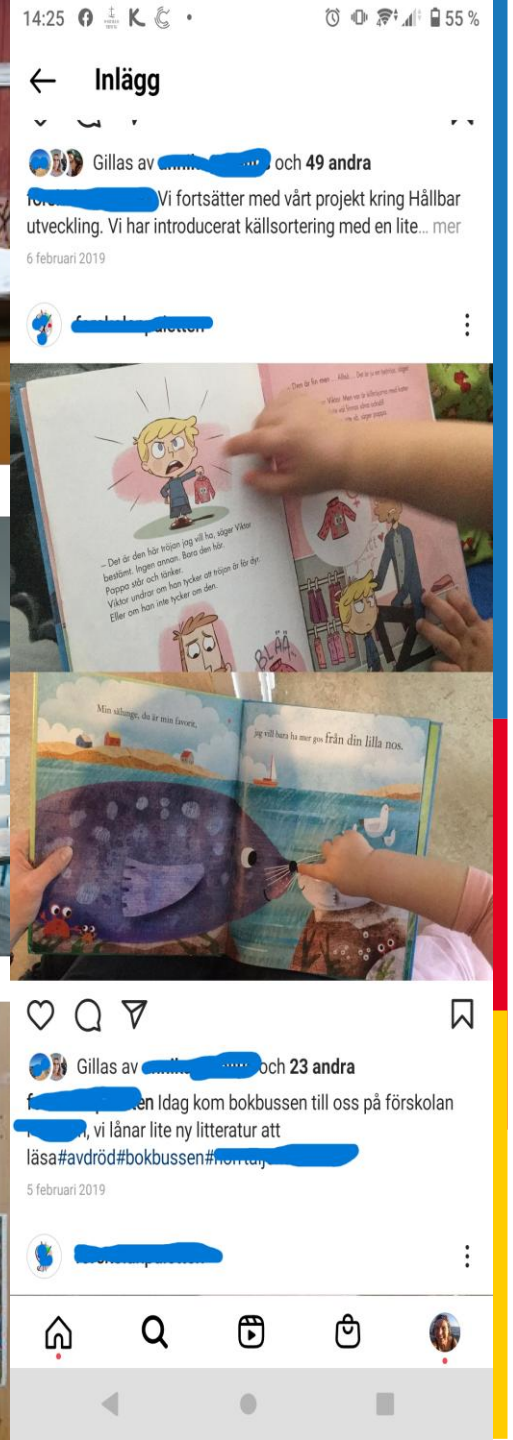
Why phenomenons in Swedish Preschool matters

- About 90% of all children in Sweden are enrolled i preschool some period between 1-5 years old.
- Swedish preschool is inspired by the Reggio Emilia pedagogy, uses pedagogical documentation, and children's participation is considered important.
- Pedagogical documentation now becomes increasingly digital.
- Does more visibility mean more participation?









Photographs in/of preschool

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Printed documentation	Digital documentation
Walls & binders	Platforms & apps
Shared reflection	Instant distribution
Local visibility	Broadcast + narrowcast

Aims and research questions

The study aims to examine how preschool children are represented and positioned within digital documentation flows, and how audience-adapted communication shapes possibilities for participation.

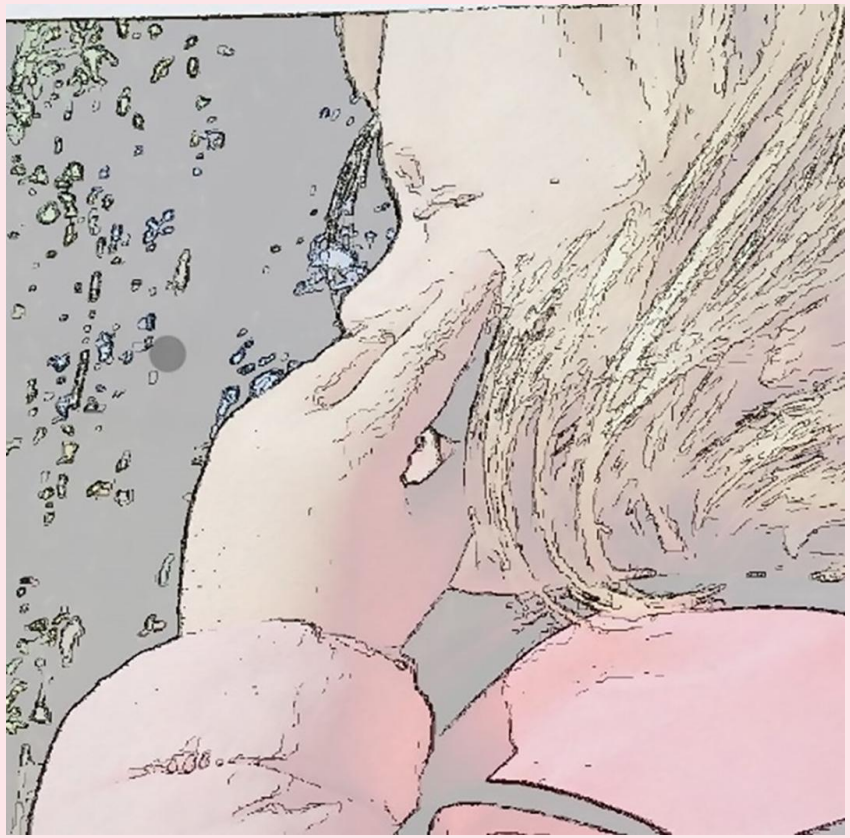
- How are children represented in narrowcasted communication?
- Differences between broadcast & narrowcast?
- What does this mean for participation?

Theoretical lenses

- Mediatization (Schulz): Media reshape institutions
- Audience size (Barasch & Berger): Audience affects content
- Normalisation (Foucault): Repetition makes norms

Material and methods

- 140 photos
- 12 children
- Individual digital folders
- Critical image analysis (Rose)





Finding 1: Uneven and selective visibility

- 3–22 photos per child
- Some highly recognisable
- Some almost invisible
- Some folders full of materials/nature

Narrowcasting does not guarantee equal visibility.



Finding 2: singularised child

- Children shown alone
- No peers
- Faces in ~45%
- Activity secondary to individual

The preschool child becomes a singular visual subject.

Broadcast	Narrowcast
Generic child	Individual child
Marketing logic	Relational variability
Stable norms	Uneven visibility

Politics of visibility

- Being seen is not the same as being heard.
- Who becomes recognisable and who remains peripheral?
- Who controls representation? (Adults)
- The child goes from relational subject to visually mediated object.

Conclusions



- Digital documentation redistributes visibility.
- Narrowcasting is not inherently more participatory.
- Mediatization may normalise a visually recognisable but adult-defined preschool child.

What kind of preschool child is produced through digital visibility?